

One Photographer. Eighteen Occupy Encampments. One Visual Archive.

Occupy Wall Street Photos marks the 15th anniversary of the Occupy movement with the launch of a chronological documentary archive.

September 2026

Fifteen years after Occupy Wall Street transformed a small encampment in New York City's Zuccotti Park into a global movement, Bulgarian-American documentary photographer **Vance Petrunoff** announces the completion of a chronological visual archive documenting the movement across the United States.

Between October 2011 and May 2012, Petrunoff traveled from camp to camp documenting the movement as it spread from New York to California and Hawaii. His journey resulted in the photographic documentation of **18 Occupy encampments**, preserving thousands of images that capture not only demonstrations but also the everyday life of the movement: volunteers preparing meals, general assemblies, community libraries, handmade protest signs, portraits, conversations, music, art, and the temporary communities created in public spaces.

The archive is available through **Occupy Wall Street Photos**, a website that presents the work as a chronological documentary record. Each encampment is linked directly to its complete Flickr album, preserving the photographs in the order they were made and providing researchers, journalists, educators, and the public with access to the full visual record.

While much of the news coverage of Occupy focused on marches, confrontations, and police actions, Petrunoff's photographs document another side of the movement - its daily rhythms and human relationships. Community kitchens, volunteer medics, libraries, working groups, artists, musicians, families, and long conversations became as important to the story as the demonstrations themselves.

The project also preserves one of the movement's most distinctive forms of expression: its handmade signs. Created on cardboard, plywood, fabric, and salvaged materials, these signs recorded individual voices, humor, frustration, political critique, and hope. Together they form an important visual record of Occupy's culture and remain a valuable resource for future researchers studying grassroots political communication.

A unique aspect of the project was **Occupying Occupy**. As Petrunoff traveled from one city to the next, he carried photographic prints made at previous encampments and shared them directly with participants. Displayed informally in camps across the country, the photographs connected communities separated by thousands of miles and became part of the movement's ongoing dialogue.

The archive has already been presented publicly. On **September 18, 2012**, Petrunoff held a solo exhibition at **Fort Mason Center** in San Francisco. Embracing the movement's do-it-yourself spirit, photographs were mounted on cardboard and installed with duct tape, packing tape, string, and simple materials, transforming the gallery into an immersive environment that echoed the atmosphere of the encampments.

The project will be presented at **ONE Gallery in Sofia, Bulgaria**, September 1-15, 2026, coinciding with the fifteenth anniversary of the movement. The publication *Occupy USA* presents a curated selection of 142 color photographs from the archive.

About Vance Petrunoff

Vance Petrunoff is a Bulgarian-American documentary photographer. Born in Bulgaria, he left the country in 1985 and later settled in the United States. Having experienced life under a communist system where public dissent carried serious consequences, he developed a lasting appreciation for the freedoms of peaceful assembly and free expression. That perspective informed his documentary approach to the Occupy movement.

Media Contact

Vance Petrunoff

Email: vpetrunoff@me.com

Website: occupywallstreetphotos.org

Flickr Archive: [flickr.com/photos/occupywallstreetphotos/albums/](https://www.flickr.com/photos/occupywallstreetphotos/albums/)